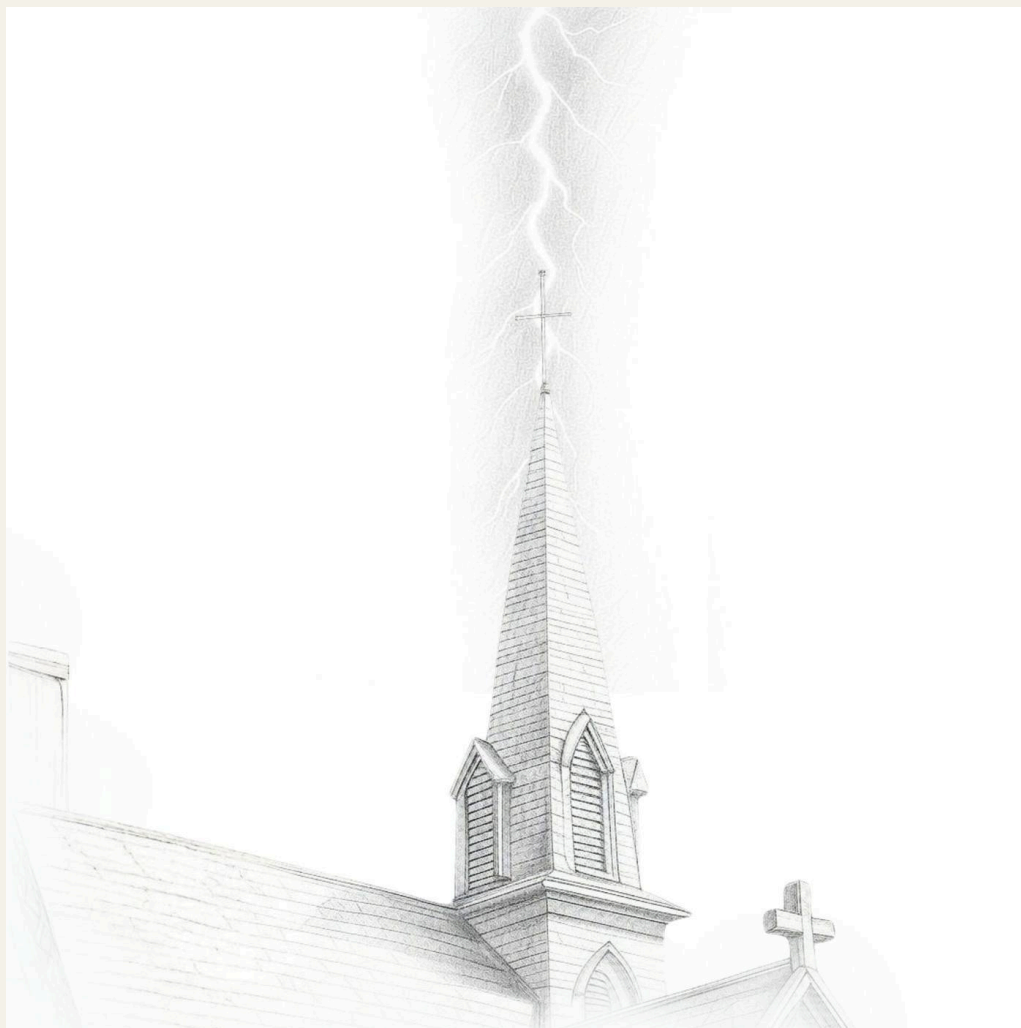


Propitiation



Lightning strikes the church steeple, the cross taking the bolt. The building is not the hero. The cross is where the storm lands.

Before you gather

- Read Day 14, Propitiation, in The Visual Gospel. Do not reteach the essay.
- Read Romans 3:24–26 in your Bible. The excerpt below is only a backup.
- Your people should already have answered the day's reflection questions. Do not ask those again.

- Leave with a name. The missional challenge only works if someone is named before you pray.

1 · ICEBREAKER · 7 MIN

Open the room

When have you been glad that someone in authority got angry at a real wrong?

Leader. Anger at evil can be right. Then open Romans 3. God's wrath is not a mood. It is answered at the cross. Say that passing is allowed, especially the first few weeks.

2 · THE WORD · 8 MIN

See it, then say it

IF YOU NEED THE WORDS

Say: Propitiation means Jesus took the wrath we deserved. God remains just, and He justifies the one who has faith in Jesus.

DEFINITION, FROM THE BOOK

Propitiation is the act by which God's just wrath against sin is fully satisfied through a sacrificial substitute, Jesus Christ, so that God's favor and forgiveness can be extended to sinners.

IN THE ORIGINAL LANGUAGE

Greek hilasmos — a sacrifice that turns away wrath, an appeasing.

MEMORY VERSE · 1 JOHN 2:2

He is the propitiation for our sins, and not for ours only but also for the sins of the whole world.

Together, open the flashcard for Propitiation. Say the word, the definition, and the verse once. Then put the phone away.

3 · OPEN THE BIBLE · 15 MIN

Romans 3:24–26

1 John 2:2 is the memory verse. Stay in Romans 3:24–26. This is where “propitiation” does its work. Do not soften wrath into disappointment.

And are justified by his grace as a gift, through the redemption that is in Christ Jesus, whom God put forward as a propitiation by his blood, to be received by faith. This was to show God’s righteousness, because in his divine forbearance he had passed over former sins. It was to show his righteousness at the present time, so that he might be just and the justifier of the one who has faith in Jesus.

Have two readers if you can. Bibles open. The excerpt is only here so a forgotten Bible does not stop the night.

From the passage

1. Romans 3:25 says God put Christ forward as a propitiation by His blood, to be received by faith. What did the blood do, and how is it received? **CORE**

Leader. The blood satisfies God's wrath against sin. It is received by faith, not by effort. Say both. Leave either out and you lose the verse.

2. Verse 26 says God is just and the justifier of the one who has faith in Jesus. Why do both words have to stay?

Leader. If He only forgave, justice would be ignored. If He only judged, there would be no gospel. The cross is how He does both. Jesus came to die.

4 · AROUND THE ROOM · 20 MIN

A conversation this chapter did not assign

3. 1 John 2:2 says Christ is the propitiation for our sins. What must we not say about the Father's anger?

Leader. Do not say love means God was never angry at sin. Propitiation means wrath was spent on Christ, not cancelled as if it were unreal.

4. If a friend says, “A loving God would never be angry,” what verse will you open, and what sentence will you say? **CORE**

Leader. Romans 3:25–26. God is just, and He justifies sinners through the blood of Jesus, received by faith.

5. Hebrews 2:17 says Jesus was made like us to make propitiation for the sins of the people. Why did the Savior need a real human life?

Leader. Wrath had to land on a real substitute, a real man who is God. He did not shout forgiveness from a distance. He came to die.

5 • SAY IT • 5 MIN

In one sentence

Propitiation means Jesus took the wrath we deserved, so God is just and the justifier of the one who has faith in Jesus.

Ask for two volunteers, not the whole circle. They may look at the sentence, then try it without looking. Clumsy and true is the goal.

6 • THIS WEEK • 5 MIN

Missional challenge

Before next week, carry this word to someone far from Jesus — a neighbor, a classmate, a coworker, a friend. Do it with a real action and with a true sentence. Name the person before you pray.

Where anger sits between you and someone far from God, move toward them without pretending the wrong was nothing. Say that God does not ignore sin, and that Jesus bore the wrath sinners deserve.

Leader. If the relationship is unsafe, do not send them back into harm. Peacemaking is not foolishness. The sentence must keep both justice and the cross. Next week, before the icebreaker, take one minute. Who went, and what happened? One sentence. No speeches.

7 • PRAY • 8 MIN

Pray these, and leave room for others

1. Holy God, You are right to hate sin. We worship You.
2. Thank You for putting Christ forward as a propitiation by His blood.
3. Give us faith in Jesus, and give us words for one person who thinks You could never be angry.

Before you stumble

Two errors will show up. One says God is love and therefore never wrathful. The other says God is angry and the cross changes nothing. Romans 3:26 answers both. Do not say everyone is already propitiated apart from faith. The verse says “received by faith.”

WITH STUDENTS

Ask what happens to a judge who lets the guilty go with no payment. Then ask what happened at the cross. Keep it short. God is just, and He justifies.

IF YOU STILL HAVE TIME

Isaiah 53:10–11. It was the will of the Lord to crush Him. This was Plan A. Read it and pray.